StoryCast: Adulting with Mitchie
Mitchell Barure · Advanced Front-End Development · ALU

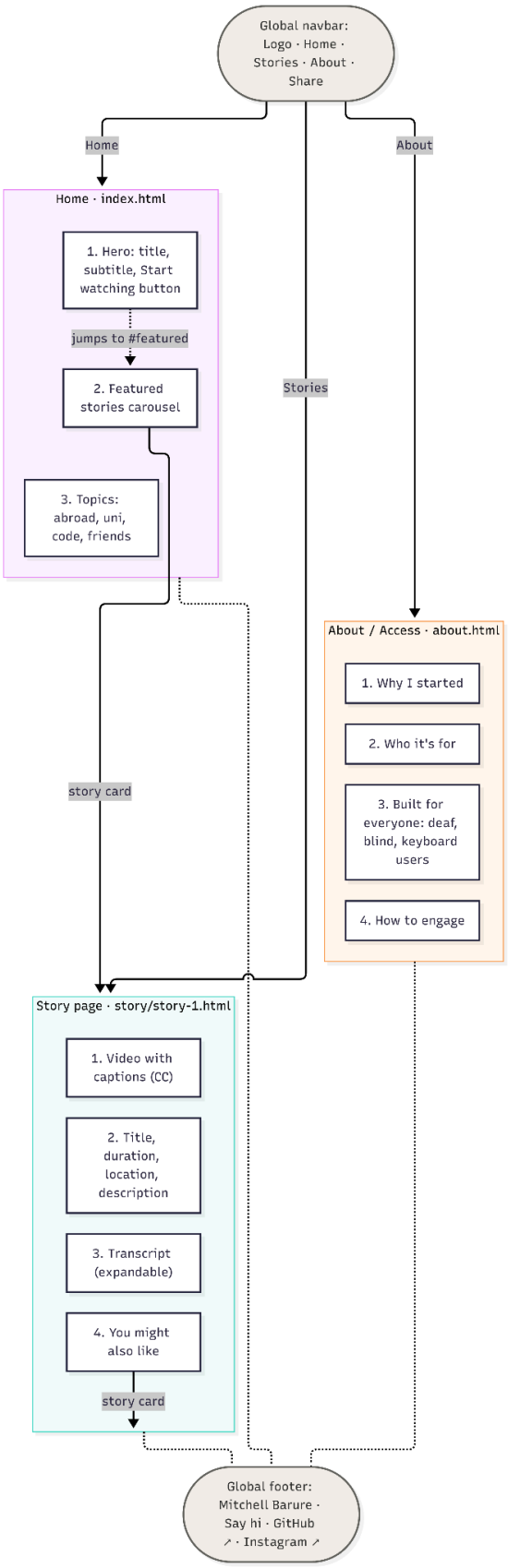
1. Purpose
StoryCast is a 3-page accessible microsite where I share short video and audio stories about studying abroad, surviving uni, learning to code and making friends as an adult. It aims to be the guide I wish I had when I moved countries for university.

2. Target audience
Young people stepping into adulthood: students about to leave home, first-years finding their feet, self-taught coders, and anyone figuring out life after school. Many browse on mobile phones with limited data, so the site is mobile-first and lightweight, with no frameworks.

3. Accessibility needs considered

- **Deaf and hard of hearing users:** captions on every video and full transcripts for every story.
- **Blind and low-vision users:** semantic HTML, a logical heading order, labelled landmarks, alt text, and WCAG AA colour contrast.
- **Keyboard-only users:** a skip link, a logical Tab order and a visible 3px focus outline.
- **People sensitive to motion:** no autoplay, no auto-moving carousel, and animations respect “reduce motion”.

4. Sitemap/Information Architecture



- Three page types (Home, Story, About) keep navigation simple, with the same header and footer on every page.

- All stories share one Story page template, so every story has the same predictable layout: media, details, transcript, then related stories.
- Home leads with featured stories so visitors reach content within one scroll. About explains the mission, accessibility features and how to engage.

5. Design decisions

- **Colours ("Playground"):** Ink `#23003F`, Cream `#F8F4EC`, Sky `#2483E2`, Lime `#E6EF5A`, Tomato `#F95D35` and Bubblegum `#F7BAD8` give a casual, playful, friendly feel. One rule keeps it accessible: bright colours are only backgrounds, and text on them is always Ink (all pairs 4.7:1 or higher).
- **Fonts:** Bricolage Grotesque for chunky, friendly headings and DM Sans for readable body text.
- **Layout:** Grid for page layouts and Flexbox for components. "You might also like" uses a container query so it adapts to its own width.

6. Process
Paper sketches → digital desktop and mobile wireframes → sitemap → high-fidelity mockups in Figma → build in HTML and Sass.

7. Colours:

My first palette was "Varsity" (navy, gold and red). After seeing it in the mockups, I changed it because it felt too formal, like an official university site, and StoryCast should feel casual and friendly. I switched to the "Playground" palette: Ink `#23003F`, Cream `#F8F4EC`, Sky `#2483E2`, Lime `#E6EF5A`, Tomato `#F95D35` and Bubblegum `#F7BAD8`. One rule keeps it accessible: bright colours are only used as backgrounds, and text on them is always Ink (every pair is 4.7:1 or higher). Some mockup screens may still show the earlier palette; the final site uses Playground.

Links

1. Wireframes
   https://www.figma.com/design/mUABK9GovTvOuVWGhHnpif/StoryCast--Mockups?node-id=2-833&p=f
2. High-fidelity Mockups
   https://www.figma.com/design/mUABK9GovTvOuVWGhHnpif/StoryCast--Mockups?node-id=0-1&p=f